

9.2 The impact of globalisation and the role of transnational corporations

- 1** List five impacts of globalisation.
- 2** Sort the following statements into economic, social and environmental impacts of transnational corporations (TNCs).
 - a** Increased foreign investment in LICs.
 - b** The movement of goods between countries increases carbon emissions.
 - c** An increase in factories can lead to poor air quality.
 - d** Increased revenue from taxes improves services such as schools and hospitals.
 - e** Profits may largely end up back in HICs.
 - f** Jobs are created in LICs.
 - g** Some TNCs work to address gender inequalities.
 - h** Some workers face unsafe working conditions.
 - i** The global reach of TNCs means the impacts of any environmental improvement programmes can be far-reaching.

UNDERSTAND THESE TERMS

- Globalisation
- Transnational corporations (TNCs)

When making decisions, geographers must consider all options and reflect on the views of others. This means that decisions are complex and there can be a spectrum of possible answers. The assessment phrase 'how far do you agree' acknowledges this by not asking for a definitive answer, but instead allowing you to say where you lie on that spectrum.

'How far do you agree' questions require you to make a decision, but you can say, for example, that you 'agree to some extent', or that you 'largely disagree', rather than fully agreeing or disagreeing. Other useful phrases to use with this type of question include 'it is partially true that', 'on the whole' or 'under certain circumstances'. These phrases allow you to show an awareness of the complexity of the question.

'How far do you agree' questions require explanation and so answers should be structured into paragraphs. A good way to do this could be to write a paragraph exploring reasons supporting your view, followed by another presenting counterarguments that you have considered. You may wish to finish with a short conclusion that confirms your position and addresses the question directly. A structure helps to ensure that your answer is clear, logical and well-balanced.

Try the following 'how far do you agree' questions:

- 3 ~~2~~ 'Globalisation brings positive economic impacts and negative environmental impacts.' How far do you agree with this statement? [7]
- 4 ~~1~~ 'Transnational corporations (TNCs) do not benefit low-income countries.' How far do you agree with this statement? [7]

There are overlaps between this topic and [Topic 8, 'The challenge of development'](#). See if you can answer these questions, which span both topics:

- a** How do TNCs impact a country's level of development?
- b** How can globalisation help to reduce global inequalities?